

Legionnaires' Disease:

What You Need to Know & How to Stay Safe

What is Legionnaires' Disease?

Legionnaires' disease is a serious lung infection caused by inhaling water droplets contaminated with Legionella bacteria. It can be found in water systems, including taps, showers, and storage tanks, particularly when water is stagnant or not kept at the correct temperature.

Who is at Risk?

While the risk is low in well-maintained systems, those with weakened immune systems, respiratory conditions, or the elderly are more vulnerable to infection.

How Can Legionella Grow?

Legionella bacteria thrive in:

- ✓ Warm water between 20°C and 45°C
- ✓ Stagnant or rarely used water outlets
- ✓ Limescale, rust, and biofilm build-up in pipes and tanks

How to Prevent Legionella in Your Home

- ✓ **Run Taps & Showers Regularly** – If a tap or shower hasn't been used in a week or more, run it for at least 2 minutes before use.
- ✓ **Keep Water at the Right Temperature** – Hot water should be stored above 60°C and come out of the tap at no less than 50°C. Cold water should stay below 20°C.
- ✓ **Clean Showerheads & Taps** – Descale and disinfect showerheads and taps at least every 3 months to prevent bacteria build-up.
- ✓ **Report Any Issues** – Let us know if you notice any unusual smells, discolouration, or low water pressure, as these could indicate a water system issue.
- ✓ **Empty Unused Outlets** – If you have an unused sink, shower, or tap, make sure it is flushed through regularly to prevent stagnation.

Your Safety Matters

At Capital Rooms, we carry out regular risk assessments and maintenance to ensure our water systems remain safe. If you have any concerns, please contact us at management@capitalrooms.co.uk.

